

'Brass' Here Is Hopeful, Awaits News

Move May Leave Vees Top Team

By Shelley Rolfe

The Denver Rocky Mountain News said last night the Yankees have terminated their working agreement with Denver of the American Association.

A break of relations between the Yankees and Denver could mean the Virginians will be the No. 1 New York farm in 1959.

The Yankees have maintained full working agreements with two Triple-A teams the past two seasons, Denver and the Virginians.

Denver became a Yankee affiliate in 1955 when the Athletics moved from Philadelphia to Kansas City. The Yankees had owned the Kansas City American Association franchise since the 1930s. The Vees first joined the Yankee family in '56 with a limited working agreement.

News that a Denver paper was reporting the Yankees were pulling out of that city was greeted with a "I hope it's so," by E. Claiborne Robins, president of the Virginians.

Robins Is Hopeful

"We know nothing about it," he said. "But I hope we can continue enjoying the fine relations we have had with the Yankees."

Herm Krattenmaker, general manager of the Virginians, said, "I can't comment on the Denver report, but we're proceeding with plans for next year with every expectation of being in the Yankee family. If the story is true, I like to think we will be the No. 1 Yankee farm."

There had been reports the Yankees were considering trimming their farm system slightly. One result, reportedly, would be cutting from two to one Triple-A farm.

The Associated Press quoted the Rocky Mountain News as saying that the Denver team also had fired Andy Cohen who managed the Bears last season. Denver finished fourth and was eliminated by Minneapolis in final round of the American Association playoffs.

Has No Comment

Bob Howsam, president of the Denver team, refused to comment on the Rocky Mountain News' story.

The paper said the break with the Yankees was by mutual consent and was amicable. The break, it said, mainly was the result of differences of opinion between the Yankees and Howsam.

Contacted at his home in El

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